

Major Assignment 2: Podcast

Podcast: Voice, Performance, and Literary Analysis**Overview****Total points:** 100

Working in teams of three, students will produce 6-8 minute roundtable podcasts. These should be enthusiastic discussions that, while partially scripted, avoid the appearance of recitation.

Our goal will be to inform *and* persuade, as teams take a perspective/stance on their chosen issue. Team members need not agree with each other, but our podcasts must generally make arguments, rather than merely summarizing the texts for listeners to decide. To add credibility to their positions, teams must orally cite the texts as well as create a Work Cited submission attached to the submission comments.

As in the real world, your podcasts will be created for intellectually diverse audiences. In your approach to your chosen topic, refrain from alienating your listeners who, through hearing your (imaginary) advertisements, fund your (imaginary) press outlet.

Due date is set for March 15, but I am more than happy to discuss extensions!

Sources

The podcast should perform a literary analysis of three texts chosen from the following:

1. Choose **one** from these (**a poem by a female poet**):
 - Katherine Philips, "[To My Excellent Lucasia, on Our Friendship](#)" (1651-1652)
 - Anne Bradstreet, "[The Author to Her Book](#)" (1678)
 - Anne Finch, "[The Introduction](#)" (1713?)
2. Choose **one** from these (**the prefatory material to a play by a female playwright**):
 - Aphra Behn, [prefatory materials](#) to *The Feigned Curtizans* (1679)
 - Delarivier Manley, [prefatory materials](#) to *The Royal Mischief* (1696)
3. Choose **one** from these (**an anti-theatrical satire**):
 - Robert Gould, "[The Playhouse. A Satyr](#)" (1689)
 - Anon., [prefatory materials](#) to *The Female Wits* (1704)

A Note on the Podcast

1. **Poetry is an auditory medium.** They have rhythm and cadence. The podcast must leverage these auditory qualities of poetry (think recitation!). While "citing" the poems to make an argument, consider reading out/reciting the relevant parts of the poem.
2. **Plays are performative**, both visually and orally. Like the poems, consider reading and/or

performing a relevant section of the preface.

3. Having a **script** helps you avoid fillers ("um", "like" etc.). But the podcast should be enthusiastic discussions that, while **partially scripted, avoid the appearance of recitation.**
4. Because this is a recorded podcast where you can **record as many takes as you like** and can also **edit**, please do what you must to ensure that it sounds as professional as possible.
5. Please make sure that the podcast episode is **structured like a back-and-forth conversation**, not a series of monologues.
6. Feel free to draw from your (and your teammates') work in Minor Assignment 2, but keep in mind that a **comparative literary analysis goes beyond close reading.**

Learning Goals

In completing the project, students will meet the following outcomes:

- Compose effective podcasts and attendant genres, such as project plans, scripts, and digital bibliographies
- Conduct inquiry-driven argumentation: navigating sources, evaluating their stances, and properly attributing ideas to avoid plagiarism
- Develop coherent narratives that successfully inform and persuade using classical rhetoric (*ethos*, *logos*, and *pathos*) and appropriate evidence
- Use the conventions and structures of enthusiast podcasts to communicate successfully
- Challenge subjective experience and assumptions by composing as part of a community and in teams

Rubric

Total Points: 100	Rating			
Criteria	Excellent	Meets Expectations	Needs Improvement	Missing
Argument & Analysis (25 points)				
Use of Evidence (25 points)				
Conversation & Organization (20 points)				
Delivery & Audience Awareness (20 points)				
Production Quality & Technical requirements (10 points)				